

MOBILE HERITAGE IN EUROPE – RESULTS OF A SURVEY



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SURVEY

The Dutch ministry of Education, Culture and Science considers a reassessment of its policy regarding mobile heritage. For that reason, a survey on mobile heritage was conducted to assess the situation and policies in various European countries. Responses from 14 countries were received. The answers have been incorporated in this short report.

MAIN RESULTS

- **Terminology:** There is not one most commonly used term that encompasses all historical vehicles used on water, road, rails, and in the air. In some countries *Mobile heritage* is used, in other countries *Transport heritage*, the latter term also includes related infrastructures such as train stations. Finally, some countries use the term *movable cultural heritage*, which is a much broader term that indicates all heritage objects that can be moved (such as artworks).
- **Legal protection:** In many participating countries, mobile heritage is protected by general laws and regulations on heritage conservation. However, several countries have additional specific regulations, such as a special category for historic vehicles within vehicle laws, or regional or local regulations protecting historic ships, trams or buses.
- **Registers:** The situation in the participating countries regarding registers is mixed. Four countries and one region report having legal registers with mobile heritage objects. Six countries report the existence of other registers (such as museum registers), while three other countries report no registers of mobile heritage objects.
- **Funding:** In 10 countries, (some) funding for mobile heritage conservation/preservation and restoration is available from the government or from other sources. Respondents from 3 countries indicate that there is no funding available in their countries for these purposes.
- **Preservation in working order:** A large majority of the respondents prefer preserving mobile heritage objects in working order, provided that the right conditions are met. Four main arguments support this preference:
 - An object in working order enables an authentic understanding of its historical and cultural significance.
 - The working order is an essential component of the heritage value of the object.
 - Objects in working order play a key role in public engagement.
 - Objects in working order help to preserve knowledge, skills and craftsmanship.

However, multiple respondents indicate that preserving objects in working order is not always feasible due to financial or technical constraints.

- **Mobile heritage seen as an integral part of heritage:** Mobile heritage is generally considered an integral part of the broader heritage sector, interconnected with built heritage, monuments, museum collections, cultural landscapes, and intangible heritage. In other words, mobile heritage is regarded and valued equally to other forms of cultural heritage. However, one respondent notes that other parts of the heritage sector are more established and therefore benefit from better conditions for conservation.

- **Role of umbrella organisations of volunteers:** In nine countries, the respondents indicate that volunteers and private owners and their umbrella organisations play a leading role in preserving mobile heritage. In these countries, there is a strong collaboration between the volunteer organisations, and the museums and the government. However, in a few other countries, the respondents state that the museum sector plays a primary role in preserving mobile heritage.
- **Outlook:** The survey paints a mixed picture for the future of the mobile heritage sector. Three countries report a positive outlook for mobile heritage, citing a growing recognition of its value and a high level of public popularity. However, there are also three countries with a more pessimistic outlook: as enthusiasts age, there is a loss of know-how and a decline of proper storage and restoration facilities. Additionally, attracting younger generations is becoming more difficult. For this question, we received relevant answers from 6 countries. The other respondents did not answer the question or interpreted it differently.
- **Sustainability:** How can the mobile heritage sector become more sustainable? This topic relates not only to environmental concerns but also to the future of mobile heritage which is at the moment often closely connected to the availability of fossil fuels. Broadly speaking, there are two perspectives reflected in the answers of the respondents:
 - One perspective explores options to make mobile heritage objects more environmentally friendly through measures such as alternative fuels or electrification. Within this perspective, the main considerations are the costs and the impact on the historical value of the objects.
 - The other perspective advocates for the continued use of fossil fuels by historic vehicles, supported by regulatory exemptions and usage restrictions, such as limiting operation to weekends or registered events.

GENERAL CONCLUSIONS

The legal situation in Europe regarding protecting mobile heritage appears to be quite uneven and shows gaps. Registers of mobile heritage objects – currently more the exception than the rule - are an important tool for providing legal protection and for directing funding towards preservation and restoration.

In many European countries, the mobile heritage sector differs from other heritage sectors due to the leading role of private owners, volunteers, and their umbrella organizations.

Preservation of mobile heritage objects in their original working order—often meaning continued use of fossil fuels—is strongly preferred over electrification or synthetic fuels. However, the sustainability of this approach is questionable for two reasons: (1) for environmental and health concerns and (2) because fossil fuels may become less available in the longer term, while alternatives like electrification or synthetic fuels may involve high costs.

Thus, sustainability casts a shadow over the future of the mobile heritage sector, along with another significant challenge: the aging population of dedicated private owners and volunteers, combined with the increasing costs of maintaining their objects.

1. INTRODUCTION

SURVEY

The Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science is reviewing its policy regarding mobile heritage and therefore initiated a survey in order to get an understand of how other countries approach this.

A survey was developed and conducted on the situation and policies in European countries, focusing on the policies and steering by the governments as well as the initiatives and needs from the sector itself.

This report on the survey results has been compiled by Maurits van der Graaf from Pleiade Management & Consultancy under the supervision of Niels van de Kamer from the Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science and Dirk Houtgraaf from the Cultural Heritage Agency of the Netherlands.

Findings in this report are based on the information provided by a limited number of respondents, from both government and the sector. This may not necessarily give a comprehensive view on the status of mobile heritage or may not reflect the general opinion in these countries. Nevertheless, It gives a valuable insight in how mobile heritages is regarded and how this differs from country to country.

DISTRIBUTION

The questionnaire has been distributed via:

- The headquarters of the [European Heritage Legal Forum - European Heritage Heads Forum](#) (EHLF).
- The survey form has also been sent to several European organisations in the network of the [Stichting Mobiele Collectie Nederland](#) (such as the FIVA - the [Fédération Internationale des Véhicules Anciens](#)).

RESPONDENTS

The survey gathered information from 14 countries. From two countries, survey forms were received from both governmental agencies and a sector organisation.

The survey form contained 10 questions: one question on terminology, four questions on protection and registers, one question on preservation, one question on the stakeholders in mobile heritage, one question on the context and outlook for mobile heritage and, finally, two questions on sustainability.

Table 1 presents the survey participants by country.

Country	Government or sector organisation	Organisation
Finland	Government	Finnish Heritage Agency
	Sector	Historical Vehicle Association of Finland (SAHK)
Croatia	Government	Ministry of Culture and Media
Malta	Government	Superintendence of Cultural Heritage
Norway	Sector	Norwegian Federation of Historic Vehicle Clubs (LMK)
Ukraine	Government	Ministry of Culture and Strategic Communications
Scotland	Government	National Heritage Organisation
Slovenia	Government	Technical Museum of Slovenia
Slovakia	Government	Monument Board
United Kingdom	Sector	Museums and Heritage Rail
Belgium/Flanders	Government	Flanders Heritage Agency
	Sector	Belgian Historic Vehicle Association (BEHVA)
Sweden	Government	n.a. ('public authority')
Netherlands	Government	Ministry of Education, Culture and Science
Denmark	Sector	Motor History Council
Moldavia	Sector	ANF – National Federation Retromobile

Table 1 Survey participants per country

2. TERMINOLOGY

MAIN RESULTS

- **A definition of mobile heritage was presented to the respondents:** Mobile heritage is an umbrella term including all historical vehicles on water (historical ships), rail (historical trains and trams), road (historical cars, motorcycles, and other road vehicles) and air (historical aircraft). It includes also (motor)bikes, carriages driven by horses, historical farm equipment, and military vehicles. It includes collections or objects owned by museums, private corporations and private owners.
- **Survey question:** Mobile heritage is in use as an umbrella term. Do you also have and use such an umbrella term and if so, what does it include?
- **Conclusion:** There is not one most commonly used term that encompasses all historical vehicles used on water, road, rails, and in the air. In some countries *Mobile heritage* is used, in other countries *Transport heritage*. The latter term also includes related infrastructures such as train stations. Finally, some countries use the term *movable cultural heritage*, which is a much broader term that indicates all heritage objects that can be moved.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- In the UK, Sweden, Belgium, and the Netherlands the term **mobile heritage** is used.
- In Finland and Slovakia, the term **transport heritage** is in use. This includes the infrastructure that is related to mobile heritage, such as harbours, bridges, and railway buildings.
- In Croatia, Slovenia and Norway, the term **movable cultural heritage** is used. However, this has a much broader definition than just historical vehicles. A similarly broad term – portable collections – is in use in Scotland.
- In Denmark, Ukraine and Moldavia, there is no umbrella term used.

3. PROTECTION BY LAW

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey question:** Is mobile heritage protected by law in your country? If so, in what form and to what extent?
- **Conclusion:** In most participating countries, mobile heritage objects – for example as part of museum collections – can be protected by general laws and/or regulations on heritage conservation. However, several countries have additional specific regulations for mobile heritage objects that offer a more direct protection, such as a special category for historic vehicles within vehicle laws, or regional or local regulations protecting historic ships, trams or buses.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- **No specific legislation on the protection of mobile heritage, but often other regulations in place:**
 - Respondents from Norway, Finland, Belgium, Denmark, the United Kingdom, and the Netherlands mention that there is no specific legislation for the protection of mobile heritage. In the Netherlands, mobile heritage is covered in a Heritage Act, but no specific objects are protected by law.
 - However, often other regulations are in place. In Finland, Denmark and Norway, historic vehicles are classified as a special category in the Vehicle Act. A similar regulation for historic vehicles is implemented in Belgium, while in the Flemish region, historic vessels are protected. Similarly, in the Netherlands, some local governments have granted protection to mobile heritage such as ships, trams, or historical busses. Finally, in Moldavia, the Ministry of Culture has a classification of historic cars.
- **Protection via general legislation or regulations:**
 - The respondents from Croatia, Malta, the Netherlands, Scotland, Slovenia, and Sweden state that mobile heritage falls under general heritage protection laws.
- **Protected if part of a museum collection:**
 - The respondent from Ukraine states that mobile heritage is part of general laws protecting heritage, especially regarding museum objects. The protection of museum collections is also mentioned by the respondent from Slovakia.

4. REGISTERS

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey questions:**
 - Is there a *legal* register or list of protected objects? If so: How was this selection made?
 - Are there any lists or registers without legal status in your country that play a role in the protection of mobile heritage?
- **Conclusion:** The situation in the participating countries regarding registers is mixed. Four countries and one region report having legal registers with mobile heritage objects. Six countries report the existence of other registers (such as museum registers), while three other countries report no registers of mobile heritage objects.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- **Legal registers:**
 - Respondents from Croatia, Malta, Slovakia, Flanders (Belgium), Moldavia, and Ukraine report the existence of legal registers with mobile heritage objects.
 - Croatia maintains the register of Cultural Property of the Republic of Croatia. This is the public record of cultural property kept by the Ministry of Culture and Media. The register is publicly available, except for movable cultural heritage, which is available only upon request. Selection is based on proposals from regional conservation departments, expert evaluations, and assessments by the Commission for the Register of the Ministry. Museum objects automatically acquire the status of cultural property.
 - Malta also has a national inventory. Each item is individually assessed by professional officers, based on pre-established criteria.
 - The Monument Board of the Slovak Republic maintains a register of all monument heritage. The museums are responsible for providing input for this register. Historical cars fall under the responsibility of the Association of Historic Vehicle Collectors of the Slovak Republic.
 - In Flanders, the Flanders Heritage Agency maintains an inventory of historic vessels.
 - In Moldavia, the national federation Retromobile maintains a register including cars that are classified by the Ministry of Culture.
 - The respondent from Ukraine mentions that work is underway to establish a legal register of protected heritage objects.
- **Other registers:**
 - Respondents from Finland, the Netherlands and Norway report the existence of other registers:
 - In Finland, the Finnish Heritage Agency maintains a register of historic vessels. Additionally, the Finnish Railway Museum has begun an inventory of railway units. The State Railways have also begun an inventory of historic equipment they own. The Finnish Aviation Museum has also compiled an inventory of preserved aircraft. Finally, approximately 65,000 to 70,000 road transport

vehicles are officially recognized as museum vehicles. This register is maintained by the Finnish Vehicle Historical Society.

- In the Netherlands, the NRME (National Register of Mobile Heritage) is developed by the umbrella organization MCN. This register aims to provide insight in the number of objects and their historical value. Additionally, the website 'Toonbeelden van mobiel erfgoed' ('Paragons of mobile heritage') describes the history of transport, highlighting certain excellent examples.
 - In Norway, there are no legal registers specifically for mobile heritage. However, various organisations document mobile heritage objects.
- **Museum collections:**
 - Respondents from Scotland and the UK report museum collections containing mobile heritage objects.
 - **No registers:**
 - Respondents from Norway, Denmark, and the UK report that to their knowledge no registers exist for mobile heritage objects in their countries.

5. FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR CONSERVATION

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey question:** Are there government or fund/lottery grants for mobile heritage conservation? If so, which acts on mobile heritage are subsidised?
- **Conclusion:** In 10 countries, (some) funding for mobile heritage conservation/preservation and restoration is available from the government or from other sources. Respondents from 3 countries indicate that there is no funding available in their countries for these purposes.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- **Governmental funding:**
 - Respondents from Finland, Croatia, Norway, the United Kingdom, Flanders (Belgium), the Netherlands, Sweden, and Denmark report funding from governmental agencies:
 - The Finnish Heritage Agency provides financial support for transport-related cultural heritage projects. Funding is prioritised for projects that preserve or restore means of transport to operable conditions.
 - In Croatia, governmental funding is available for registered objects, along with an additional funding stream called ‘the monument rent’.
 - In Norway, government grants are available depending on the type of vehicle. There are specific funding streams for historic ships. For historic vehicles such as cars, funding is available through the Norwegian Cultural Heritage Fund.
 - In Flanders, the Flemish government provides funding for the maintenance and restoration for protected historic vessels. At the national level, no governmental subsidies are available for mobile heritage.
 - In Sweden, the Swedish National Heritage Board provides grants for cultural heritage conservation, which can also be used for mobile heritage objects.
 - In the Netherlands, a specific fund for the restoration of mobile heritage is provided by the state-funded Mondriaan Fund.
 - In the United Kingdom, the Arts Council provides government-funded support.
 - The respondent from Denmark states that governmental subsidies are available for the preservation of historic railways, but these subsidies are sporadic and depend on the annual state budget.
- **Other funding:**
 - The respondent from the United Kingdom states that funding is available through the National Lottery and other charitable organisations.
 - The respondent from Slovakia reports that museums are funded by state or municipal budgets, including conservation costs.
- **No funding:**
 - Respondents of Malta, Moldavia and Slovakia report that no funding is available.

7. PRESERVATION IN WORKING CONDITION

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey question:** Would you agree that mobile heritage should be preserved in working condition (in working order) - if possible?
- **Conclusion:**
 - A large majority of the respondents prefer preserving mobile heritage objects in working order, provided that the right conditions are met. Four main arguments support this preference: (1) an object in working order enables an authentic understanding of its historical and cultural significance; (2) the working order is an intangible component of the heritage value of the object; (3) objects in working order play a key role in public engagement; (4) objects in working order help to preserve knowledge, skills and craftsmanship.
 - However, multiple respondents indicate that preserving objects in working order is not always feasible due to financial or technical constraints.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

All respondents answered this question, and all – except for one – agreed with the statement ‘if the conditions are met’.

The arguments pro working order in the responses can be summarised as follows:

- Mobile heritage in working order enables a dynamic and authentic understanding of its historical and cultural significance.
- An object’s working order is also a crucial intangible component of its heritage value. In this respect, one respondent highlights the smells and sounds as key characteristics of a historic vehicle.
- Mobile heritage in working order plays a key role in public engagement. As one respondent put it: ‘a massive amount of fun’.
- Maintaining mobile heritage in working order helps preserve knowledge, skills and craftsmanship.

However, in practice, it is not always feasible to maintain the objects in working order:

- In Finland, the Finnish Heritage Agency has chosen to provide financial support for mobile heritage objects owned by NGOs and private individuals. The mobile heritage objects in museums are often not in working order, as museums rarely have the necessary resources.
- The respondent from Norway notes that there is a balance between the need for preservation and the requirements for maintaining operational status. The latter sometimes requires modifications that may compromise the authenticity of the original object. The respondent from Malta echoes this sentiment, stating that maintain proper working conditions should not significantly alter the object itself. However, the respondent from Flanders argues that a well-functioning historic vessel has the best chance of survival.

- The respondent from Slovenia states that they adhere to the ICOM Code of Ethics. In practice, they keep some objects in working order, but only those with a lower status.
- The respondent from Scotland states that objects are kept in working order on a case-by-case basis, depending on cost-benefit analysis and cultural value.
- In Ukraine, mobile heritage objects in state museums are not in working order. However, some private museums do have objects that are in working order.

8. ROLE OF THE VARIOUS ACTORS IN THE HERITAGE SECTOR REGARDING MOBILE HERITAGE

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey question:** What role do umbrella organisations, museums, volunteers, and private owners play within the mobile heritage sector in your country in protecting mobile heritage? Does the government have a role in this too?
- **Conclusion:** In nine countries, the respondents indicate that volunteers and private owners and their umbrella organisations play a leading role in preserving mobile heritage. In these countries, there is a strong collaboration between the volunteer organisations, museums and the government. However, in a few other countries, the respondents state that the museum sector plays a primary role in mobile heritage.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- The respondent of Norway states that the protection and preservation of mobile heritage is a collaborative effort and a shared responsibility of four key stakeholders:
 - **Umbrella Organizations:** Umbrella organizations like LMK (the Norwegian Federation of Historic Vehicle Clubs) play a significant role in advocating for the interests of historic vehicle owners and enthusiasts. They provide a unified voice when engaging with policymakers, offer guidance and resources for preservation efforts, and organize events that celebrate and promote mobile heritage.
 - **Volunteers and private owners:** Volunteers are the backbone of many preservation projects in Norway. They contribute their time, expertise, and passion to restoring and maintaining historic vehicles and other forms of mobile heritage. Many volunteers are members of local clubs or associations and participate in events, workshops, and restoration projects, ensuring that these cultural treasures are preserved for future generations. Private owners of historic vehicles and other mobile heritage items are also crucial to preservation efforts. They often invest significant resources into the maintenance and restoration of their collections. Many of these owners are active participants in the community, displaying their vehicles at events, exhibitions, and public gatherings, thereby helping to keep the history and culture associated with these items alive.
 - **Museums:** Museums play a critical role in preserving mobile heritage by curating and maintaining collections of historic vehicles, ships, and other artifacts. They provide educational resources to the public, host exhibitions, and often collaborate with other institutions to enhance the understanding and appreciation of mobile heritage.
 - **Government:** The Norwegian government also plays a role in the protection of mobile heritage, primarily through regulatory frameworks and financial support. While the government provides some funding through grants – particularly via the Norwegian Cultural Heritage Fund (Kulturminnefondet) – its role is more facilitative, supporting the efforts of private individuals, organizations, and museums. Additionally, the government ensures that historic vehicles over 30 years old benefit from certain tax exemptions, which aids in their preservation.
- Respondents from Finland, Sweden, the Netherlands, Ukraine, Belgium, Moldavia, and Denmark also highlight the crucial importance of the volunteers and private owners/collectors in

preserving mobile heritage. They highlight the interaction between volunteers/private owners, their umbrella organisations, museums, and the government.

- Respondents from Croatia, Slovenia, and Slovakia primarily see the museum sector playing a leading role in the preservation and protection of mobile heritage, while volunteers and private owners are mentioned only as secondary actors or not at all.

9. RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN MOBILE HERITAGE AND OTHER AREAS OF THE HERITAGE SECTOR

SURVEY QUESTION

- **Survey question:** What relationship exists between mobile heritage in your country and other areas of the heritage sector such as built heritage/monuments, museum collections, cultural landscape and intangible heritage?
- **Conclusion:** Mobile heritage is generally considered an integral part of the broader heritage sector, interconnected with built heritage, monuments, museum collections, cultural landscapes, and intangible heritage. In other words, mobile heritage is regarded and valued equally to other forms of cultural heritage. However, one respondent notes that other parts of the heritage sector are more established and therefore benefit from better conditions for conservation.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

The respondent from Norway gives an elaborate answer to this question:

- In Norway, mobile heritage is an integral part of the broader heritage sector, closely interconnected with other areas such as built heritage, monuments, museum collections, cultural landscapes, and intangible heritage.
 - **Built Heritage/Monuments:** Mobile heritage, particularly historic vehicles and ships, often interacts with built heritage and monuments. For example, historic vehicles may be showcased in events or parades held at significant historical sites, linking transportation history with the built environment. Additionally, historic ships are often preserved and displayed in maritime heritage sites, contributing to the overall historical narrative of the area.
 - **Museum Collections:** Museums play a crucial role in curating and preserving mobile heritage alongside other historical artifacts. Vehicles, ships, and aircraft are often part of museum collections, where they are displayed not only as technological achievements but also as cultural and historical artifacts that reflect societal changes and advancements over time. These exhibits often complement collections of built heritage or other historical objects, providing a holistic view of the past.
 - **Cultural Landscape:** Mobile heritage contributes to the cultural landscape by preserving the historical context in which these vehicles, ships, and other forms of transportation operated. For example, historic roads, railways, and maritime routes are often part of Norway's cultural landscapes, and the vehicles that once traversed these paths are preserved as part of that heritage. This connection enhances the understanding of how transportation shaped the development and character of different regions.
 - **Intangible Heritage:** Mobile heritage also intersects with intangible cultural heritage, particularly in the traditions, skills, and knowledge associated with the maintenance, restoration, and operation of historic vehicles and ships. Enthusiasts and experts who work on these artifacts are preserving not just the physical objects, but also the intangible heritage of craftsmanship, engineering knowledge, and cultural practices related to transportation.
- The respondent from Denmark states that other parts of the cultural heritage sector are more established and therefore have better conditions for conservation.

- Two respondents focused their answers on the relationship between monuments and mobile heritage. They sometimes mention an overlap. For example, heritage railways, tramways, and other forms of historic mobile heritage are sometimes stored in monuments
- Other respondents interpreted the question differently and states, for example, that mobile heritage is regarded and valued equally to other types of cultural heritage.

10. OUTLOOK

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey question:** What is the outlook for mobile heritage in use (used) in your country?
- **Conclusion:** The survey paints a mixed picture for the future of mobile heritage sector. Three countries report a positive outlook for mobile heritage, citing a growing recognition of its value and a high level of public popularity. However, there are also three countries with a more pessimistic outlook. As enthusiasts age, there is a loss of know-how and a decline of proper storage and restoration facilities. Additionally, attracting younger generations is becoming more difficult. For this question, we received relevant answers from 6 countries. The other respondents did not answer the question or interpreted it differently.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

- **Positive outlook:** Three respondents report a generally positive outlook:
 - The respondent from Norway provides the following outlook:
 - There is a growing recognition of the value of keeping historic vehicles, ships, and other mobile heritage in working order, both for educational purposes and for public enjoyment. Events such as vintage car rallies, historic ship regattas, and aviation displays remain popular and help sustain public interest in these artifacts.
 - The support from organizations like LMK, as well as international bodies like FIVA, has been crucial in promoting the preservation and use of mobile heritage. These organizations advocate for the continued use of historic vehicles and ships, emphasizing their importance as living heritage that can be experienced in action, rather than just as static displays.
 - However, challenges remain, particularly regarding the balance between preservation and modernization. As environmental regulations and safety standards evolve, it is important to find ways to maintain the usability of historic vehicles without compromising their historical integrity.
 - Overall, with continued support from enthusiasts, organizations, and the government, mobile heritage in Norway is likely to remain vibrant and active, providing a dynamic link to the past.
 - Other respondents with a positive outlook report the following:
 - In Slovenia, the use of vintage cars and trains is encouraged with among others a special licence to operate in traffic.
 - A respondent from Belgium reports a positive outlook but emphasizes the need for ongoing advocacy to protect the rights of owners to use their historic vehicles on public roads and in inner cities, especially in Low Emission Zones.
- **Negative outlook:** Three respondents report a more pessimistic outlook:
 - The respondent from Finland highlights concerns about the ageing of enthusiasts, the loss of know-how, and the disappearance of proper storage and restoration facilities.
 - The respondent from the United Kingdom reports a downturn in the number of volunteers since the Covid-19 pandemic. It seems that younger generations are less

interested in mobile heritage than older generations. This respondent foresees a significant need for increased marketing efforts.

- The respondent from Denmark echoes this concern, noting that interest in mobile heritage appears to be declining. Attracting younger people is particularly challenging, partly because owning and maintaining mobile heritage is an expensive hobby. Additionally, this respondent observes that finding volunteers for cultural organisations is becoming increasingly difficult.

- **Additional comments:**

- A few respondents provide more specific remarks on the outlook:
 - The respondent from Slovakia notes that mobile heritage objects in museums will follow the collection policies of the individual institutions. A general framework exists for presenting historic vehicles at events, along with specific rules governing their use in traffic.
 - The respondent from Croatia states that most historic vehicles are displayed in museums. Only a few historic vessels are still in use.

11. SUSTAINABILITY

MAIN RESULTS

- **Survey questions:** There were two survey questions related to the topic of sustainability:
 - *Considerations regarding sustainability:*
 - To what extent are there thoughts about making mobile heritage more sustainable, for example by phasing out fossil fuels and using more sustainable energy? (a) by the government; (b) by owners, museums, or private organisations.
 - What opportunities and/or obstacles do you see around the use of synthetic/sustainable fuels for mobile heritage? Think for example also about exemptions for mobile heritage in the use of fuels.
 - *Policies regarding sustainability*
 - Are there specific policies aimed at encouraging sustainable behaviour among mobile heritage owners?
 - Are concrete actions or projects taking place to make mobile heritage more sustainable? If so, do you know of any practical examples you can and/or would like to share with us?
 - Are there partnerships or activities organised in which sustainability is encouraged or facilitated for mobile heritage owners?
- **Conclusion:** The survey showed two different perspectives that were reflected in the answers of the respondents:
 - One perspective explores options to make mobile heritage objects more environmentally friendly through measures such as alternative fuels or electrification. Within this perspective, the main considerations are the costs and the impact on the historical value of the objects.
 - The other perspective advocates for the continued use of fossil fuels by historic vehicles, supported by regulatory exemptions and usage restrictions, such as limiting operation to weekends or registered events.
 - Four respondents did not respond to this question.

OVERVIEW OF THE RESPONSES

GOVERNMENTAL REGULATIONS AND POLICIES

Two respondents mention the proposed EU regulation that aiming to phase out passenger cars and light commercial vehicles using fossil fuels by 2035. One respondent refers to it as the 'End-of-Life Vehicles' regulation.

The respondent from Croatia mentions a special law on climate change and ozone layer protection in that country. The respondent from Denmark states that government policies on climate include the phase-out of fossil fuels. However, the respondent notes that this is not necessarily a direct phase-out but rather a gradual transition driven by the development of alternatives to fossil fuels.

The respondent from the Netherlands states that the Ministry of Culture is reviewing its position on mobile heritage, including the role of sustainability. The current policy mainly focuses on providing knowledge and raising awareness.

In the UK, the government has granted an exemption for the use of fossil fuels on Heritage Rail.

The respondents from Finland and Malta state explicitly that there are no governmental regulations in this regard.

OTHER POLICY INITIATIVES

The following initiatives have been mentioned:

- The respondent from Croatia states that as part of efforts to mitigate the effects of climate change, their future task will be to develop concrete actions and projects, as well as to raise awareness among private owners to enhance the sustainability of mobile heritage. In this regard, they aim to intensify activities and partnerships with mobile heritage owners.
- The respondent from the UK states that all heritage relies on public support. For this reason, they must tailor their operations to be publicly acceptable.
- The respondent from the Belgian Historic Vehicle Association states that their primary objective is to promote the responsible use of historic vehicles on public roads. They do not address carbon footprint or emissions, as the average annual distance driven is barely more than a thousand kilometres, and mobile heritage is more about culture than mobility.
- In the Netherlands, an active community of organisations represents specific subsections of mobile heritage. Some of these organisations actively work on environmental sustainability. For example, the platform ‘sustainable heritage ships’ brings together several organisations. Initiatives like this have led to a separate statement issued by the umbrella organisation Mobile Heritage in the Netherlands (MCN) aiming to enhance sustainability while maintaining the objects in working order.
- At the international level, efforts are underway to develop E-fuels.
- Several companies specialise in converting historic vehicles to electric operation.
- Commercial carbon offset programs are available on the market.

CONSIDERATIONS REGARDING SUSTAINABILITY

Respondents mentioned the following topics:

- **Synthetic fuels:**
 - Adopting synthetic fuels could require modifications to mobile heritage objects, jeopardizing their originality and preservation.
 - The cost of synthetic fuels—currently ranging between €4.50 and €6.00 per litre, according to one respondent—is considered a major obstacle. Another respondent likewise considers the high cost of synthetic fuels a major obstacle. However, one

respondent states: ‘Synthetic fuels simply do not work. We have tried them. Fossil fuel is the only way’¹.

- **Electrification:**
 - Several respondents mentioned electrification of historic vehicles. This is a change of technology, which may conflict with the preservation of technology as an important part of history. One respondent was quite firm: ‘We believe that replacing the original fuel, for example, with electric, declassifies a classic car and transfers it to the category of a cheap replica.’
- **Low emission zones:**
 - Low Emission Zones are cited as a potential obstacle for private owners of historic vehicles.
- **Limited usage of historic vehicles:**
 - The respondent from the Historical Vehicle Association of Finland reports that they conduct research on the usage of historic vehicles (measured in kilometres) to inform Finnish authorities about their minimal usage and low emissions.
 - The respondent from Croatia also reports that since very few vehicles on water are in use, they are not aware of any efforts to replace their fossil fuel engines.
- **Other environmental concerns:**
 - The Flanders Heritage Agency states that it is becoming increasingly challenging to reconcile heritage conservation for vessels with increasingly strict regulations. Beyond fossil fuels for engines, the measures required to make vessels watertight—protecting them from harmful aquatic organisms—are often environmentally harmful. Traditional shipbuilding and maintenance methods can sometimes no longer be applied.

These considerations result in varying perspectives by different respondents:

- **A range of perspectives within the sector:** One respondent describes different perspectives within the sector. Several initiatives by individual actors have initiated efforts to reduce the environmental impact. For example, efforts are being made to reduce coal usage in traditional railway vehicles. Other initiatives focus on minimizing the spillage of harmful substances such as oil. However, some sector actors consider the use of fossil fuels an intrinsic part of cultural heritage itself, citing the smell of coal or gasoline and the sound of combustion engines as essential elements. Therefore, they view the elimination of this aspect of cultural heritage as an obstacle to the sustainable transformation of historic vehicles. Others do not see this as a limitation and advocate for the electrification of heritage vehicles to ensure their continued use.
- **Several respondents emphasized both environmental and financial concerns:**
 - One respondent notes that private owners often lack the financial means to replace fossil fuels with more sustainable energy sources without public institutional support. They also note a lack of awareness regarding the importance of replacing fossil fuels with sustainable alternatives.

¹ This statement is probably related to coal as a fossil fuel.

- Another respondent states that they use historical vehicles (mostly not in working order) to educate the public about fossil fuels.
- According to another respondent, general car policies focus on transitioning to electric vehicles or hydrogen, reducing attention to fuels like HVO, thereby making them more expensive and harder to obtain.
- Another respondent foresees that when the world shifts to alternatives to fossil fuels, the production and distribution will become more expensive, thus increasing the costs for owners of historic vehicles. This might require financial support from the government.
- **Several respondents advocate for the continued use of fossil fuels, along with exemptions for historic vehicles:** These respondents downplay the environmental impact of historic vehicles due to their limited use and advocate for the continued use of fossil fuels. Therefore, they call for an exemption for historical vehicles, coupled with usage restrictions, such as limiting operation to weekends or registered events.